Bacterial Food Poisoning

Certain bacteria present in food produce toxins that are injurious to health. The four types of food poisoning are:

1. *Salmonella food poisoning*
2. *Staphylococcal poisoning*
3. *Botulism*
4. *Clostridium perfringens food poisoning*

Table 8.1 shows the major food poisoning of bacterial origin.

Table 8.1 Major Food Poisoning of Bacterial Origin

Details	Salmonellosis	Staphylococcal poisoning	Botulism	Clostridium perfringens poisoning
Bacteria	Salmonella	*Staphylococcus aureus*	*Clostridium botulinum*	*Clostridium perfringens*
Incubation period	6-48 hours	1-6 hours	12-36 hours	8-22 hours
Duration of illness	2-3 days	1-2 days	Several days to a year	One day
Symptoms	Headache, abdominal pain.  ▲ Plate 8.13 Symptoms	Abdominal pain, nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea.	Fatigue, headache, dizziness, visual disturbances, inability to swallow.	Abdominal pain, diarrhoea  ▲ Plate 8.14 Signs of Food Poisoning
Foods affected	Meat, meat products, poultry, salads,egg custards and other protein foods.	Improperly prepared custards, cream filled pastries,dairy products, meat poultry, salads.	Improperly processed canned foods, mushrooms, tuna, figs.	Boiled,steamed, braised, stewed meat.
Prevention	* Strict personal hygiene * Avoidance of fecal contamination from unclean food handlers. * Unsafe practices.	* Cleanliness and sanitary habits. * Proper heating and refrigeration. * Exclusion of infected food handlers.	* Pressure cooking food at high temperatures in canning. * Boiling and stirring home canned food for 20 minutes.	* Careful time and temperature control. * Quick chilling of cooked meat dishes. * Isolation of raw and cooked foods.

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